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TECHNICAL DEVELOPER DOCUMENTATION

NEXUS HRMS

Human Resource Management System

Comprehensive technical documentation for the NEXUS HRMS platform, covering system architecture, API specifications, database schema, frontend architecture, security model, deployment procedures, and development guidelines for engineering teams.

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1. Introduction to NEXUS HRMS

1.1 What is NEXUS HRMS

NEXUS HRMS (Human Resource Management System) is a comprehensive, cloud-based platform designed to streamline and automate all aspects of human resource management within an organization. It provides a unified digital workspace where HR professionals, managers, and employees can collaborate efficiently across the entire employee lifecycle, from recruitment and onboarding to performance management and offboarding. The system replaces fragmented manual processes with integrated digital workflows, reducing administrative overhead and ensuring compliance with organizational policies and regulatory requirements.

Built on modern architecture, NEXUS HRMS offers a responsive web interface accessible from any device, real-time data synchronization, and role-based access controls that protect sensitive employee information while enabling efficient collaboration. The platform supports multi-branch and multi-department operations, making it suitable for organizations of all sizes, from growing startups to large enterprises with distributed teams across multiple locations.

1.2 Key Features Overview

NEXUS HRMS encompasses a wide range of modules, each designed to address specific HR functions. The following table summarizes the core modules and their primary purposes:

Module	Purpose	Key Users
Dashboard	Centralized KPI monitoring and quick actions	All Users
Employee Management	Employee records, profiles, and status tracking	HR, Managers
Recruitment (ATS)	Job postings, candidate pipeline, and hiring	HR, Recruiters
Attendance & Leave	Time tracking, leave management, shifts	All Users
Payroll	Salary processing, deductions, and payslips	HR, Finance
Performance	Goals, reviews, and 360-degree feedback	HR, Managers, Employees
Learning & Development	Training courses and certifications	HR, Employees
Travel & Expense	Travel requests and expense reimbursement	All Users
Helpdesk	Support tickets and knowledge base	All Users
Asset Management	Asset requests, assignment, and returns	HR, IT, Employees
Compliance	Regulatory calendars and audit preparation	HR, Legal
Workflow Builder	Custom workflow definitions and approvals	Admin, HR

1.3 Getting Started

To begin using NEXUS HRMS, follow these steps to log in and navigate the system:

Step 1. Open your web browser and navigate to the NEXUS HRMS URL provided by your organization (typically <https://hrms.yourcompany.com>).

Step 2. Enter your corporate email address and password on the login page. First-time users will receive a temporary password via email.

Step 3. If this is your first login, you will be prompted to change your password and set up multi-factor authentication (MFA). Follow the on-screen instructions.

Step 4. After logging in, you will land on the Dashboard, which serves as your central hub. The left sidebar contains navigation links to all modules.

Step 5. Use the global search bar at the top of the page to quickly find employees, candidates, tickets, or any records across the system.

Step 6. Click your profile icon in the top-right corner to access account settings, notification preferences, and the logout option.

Note: If you have trouble logging in, contact your HR administrator or use the "Forgot Password" link on the login page.

1.4 User Roles and Permissions

NEXUS HRMS uses a role-based access control (RBAC) system to ensure that each user can only access the features and data relevant to their responsibilities. The following roles are defined by default, though additional custom roles can be created by system administrators:

Role	Access Level	Typical Responsibilities
Super Admin	Full system access	System configuration, user management, all modules
HR Admin	All HR modules	Employee records, payroll, recruitment, compliance
HR Manager	Department-level HR	Approvals, reviews, recruitment oversight
Department Manager	Department scope	Team approvals, performance reviews, leave approval
Employee	Self-service	Profile view, attendance, leave requests, expense claims
Recruiter	Recruitment module	Job postings, candidate pipeline, interview scheduling

Note: Permissions can be customized at the module and action level. Contact your system administrator for role changes.

2. Dashboard Module SOP

2.1 Accessing the Dashboard

The Dashboard is the landing page after login. It provides a high-level overview of key HR metrics and quick access to frequently used actions. To access the Dashboard at any time, click the "Dashboard" link in the left sidebar or click the NEXUS HRMS logo in the top-left corner. The Dashboard is personalized based on your role: HR administrators see organization-wide metrics, while department managers see team-specific data, and employees see their personal summary.

2.2 Understanding KPI Cards

KPI (Key Performance Indicator) cards are displayed prominently at the top of the Dashboard. Each card shows a metric name, current value, trend indicator (up or down arrow), and percentage change compared to the previous period. Common KPI cards include Total Employees, Active Job Openings, Pending Leave Requests, Open Tickets, and Payroll Status. Click on any KPI card to drill down into the detailed view for that metric. The time period for comparison can be changed using the date range selector in the top-right corner of the Dashboard.

2.3 Reviewing Recent Activities

Below the KPI cards, the Recent Activities section displays a chronological feed of important events across the system. This includes new employee additions, leave approvals, ticket updates, interview schedules, and payroll completions. Each activity entry shows the event type, affected employee or record, timestamp, and the user who initiated the action. Use the filter dropdown to narrow activities by module or date range. Clicking on an activity takes you directly to the relevant record.

2.4 Quick Actions and Shortcuts

The Quick Actions panel on the right side of the Dashboard provides one-click access to the most common tasks. Available shortcuts depend on your role. HR administrators see options like "Add Employee," "Run Payroll," and "Create Job Posting." Employees see "Apply for Leave," "Check In," and "Submit Expense." You can customize your Quick Actions panel by clicking the gear icon and selecting your preferred shortcuts from the available list. Keyboard shortcuts are also available: press Ctrl+K to open the command palette for rapid navigation to any module or action.

3. Employee Management SOP

3.1 Adding a New Employee

Adding a new employee creates their profile in the system and triggers the onboarding workflow. Follow these steps to add a new employee:

Step 1. Navigate to Employee Management from the left sidebar.

Step 2. Click the "Add Employee" button in the top-right corner.

Step 3. Fill in the required personal information: First Name, Last Name, Email Address, Phone Number, and Date of Birth.

Step 4. Enter employment details: Department, Branch, Job Title, Employment Type (Full-time, Part-time, Contract), and Start Date.

Step 5. Assign the employee to a reporting manager by searching and selecting from the dropdown.

Step 6. Set the initial employee status. New hires are typically set to "Probation" status.

Step 7. Upload required documents (ID proof, address proof, educational certificates) in the Documents section.

Step 8. Click "Save" to create the employee record. The system will automatically send a welcome email with login credentials.

Note: All fields marked with an asterisk (*) are mandatory. The system will not allow you to save without completing these fields.

3.2 Editing Employee Information

Step 1. Navigate to Employee Management and locate the employee using the search bar or filters.

Step 2. Click on the employee name to open their profile.

Step 3. Click the "Edit" button in the top-right corner of the profile page.

Step 4. Update the necessary fields. Changes to sensitive fields (salary, department, manager) require approval.

Step 5. Click "Save" to apply changes. A change log entry is automatically created for audit purposes.

Note: Changes to employment terms (salary, designation, department) trigger an approval workflow before taking effect.

3.3 Searching and Filtering Employees

The Employee List page provides powerful search and filter capabilities to quickly locate employee records:

- Use the search bar at the top to search by name, employee ID, email, or phone number.
- Apply filters by clicking the "Filters" button. Available filters include Department, Branch, Status, Employment Type, and Date of Joining.
- Combine multiple filters for refined results. For example, filter by Department = "Engineering" AND Status = "Active" to see all active engineers.
- Sort the list by any column by clicking the column header. Click again to toggle ascending/descending order.
- Export the filtered list to CSV or Excel using the "Export" button for reporting purposes.

3.4 Managing Employee Status

Employee status determines the level of system access and the workflows applicable to an individual. The following statuses are supported:

Status	Description	System Access
Active	Currently employed and working	Full access
Probation	New hire in probationary period	Full access with limited self-service
On Leave	On approved leave (short-term)	Read-only access
Notice Period	Resigned, serving notice period	Limited access, data export enabled

To change an employee status, open the employee profile, click "Change Status," select the new status, provide a reason, and submit. Status changes to "Notice Period" or termination require HR admin approval. Status changes automatically trigger relevant workflows such as asset return reminders for departing employees or access provisioning for returning employees.

3.5 Viewing Employee Profiles

The employee profile page consolidates all information about an individual in a single view. It is organized into tabs: Personal Info, Employment Details, Documents, Attendance Summary, Leave History, Performance Reviews, Assigned Assets, and Activity Log. Managers and HR administrators can view all tabs; employees can only view their own profile. Use the "Quick Edit" button to make inline changes without navigating away from the profile.

3.6 Assigning Departments and Branches

Step 1. Open the employee profile and click "Edit" on the Employment Details tab.

Step 2. Select the new Department from the dropdown. Departments are configured by the system administrator.

Step 3. Select the Branch/Location. This determines the leave policies and holiday calendar applicable to the employee.

Step 4. If the employee works across multiple branches, enable the "Multi-Branch" option and select additional branches.

Step 5. Click "Save." A department or branch change triggers a notification to the current and new department managers.

Note: Changing an employee department may affect their leave policy, reporting structure, and workflow assignments. Review all implications before confirming.

4. Recruitment (ATS) SOP

4.1 Creating Job Postings

Job postings define open positions and attract candidates to your organization. To create a job posting:

- Step 1.** Navigate to Recruitment from the left sidebar and click "Job Postings."
- Step 2.** Click "Create Job Posting" to open the job creation form.
- Step 3.** Enter the Job Title, Department, Location, Employment Type, and Experience Level.
- Step 4.** Write the Job Description in the rich text editor. Include responsibilities, qualifications, and benefits.
- Step 5.** Set the Salary Range (optional but recommended for transparency).
- Step 6.** Configure the Application Form by selecting which fields candidates must complete (resume, cover letter, portfolio, custom questions).
- Step 7.** Choose the Publishing Channels: Internal job board, company career page, and/or external job boards.
- Step 8.** Set the Application Deadline and the number of positions to fill.
- Step 9.** Click "Publish" to make the job live, or "Save as Draft" to review later.

Note: Published job postings automatically appear on the selected channels. Draft postings are only visible to the recruitment team.

4.2 Reviewing Candidate Applications

As applications are received, they appear in the candidate pipeline for the corresponding job posting. To review applications:

- Step 1.** Go to Recruitment and select the job posting from the list.
- Step 2.** Click on a candidate to view their complete application: resume, cover letter, answers to custom questions, and any uploaded documents.
- Step 3.** Use the screening scorecard to rate candidates on predefined criteria (education, experience, skills, culture fit).
- Step 4.** Add internal notes and tags to organize candidates (e.g., "Strong Technical," "Needs Visa Sponsorship").
- Step 5.** Reject clearly unqualified candidates using the "Reject" button, which sends a polite rejection email. You can customize the rejection template.

4.3 Moving Candidates Through Pipeline Stages

The recruitment pipeline consists of configurable stages that reflect your hiring process. Default stages include: Applied, Screening, Phone Screen, Interview, Offer, and Hired. To move a candidate:

- Step 1.** Open the candidate profile from the pipeline view.

Step 2. Click the "Move to Next Stage" button, or drag and drop the candidate card to the desired stage in the Kanban view.

Step 3. Add a note explaining the reason for the stage change (required for rejection stages).

Step 4. The system automatically notifies the candidate of their status change if email templates are configured for that stage.

Custom pipeline stages can be created in Recruitment Settings to match your unique hiring workflow. Each stage can have associated automation rules, such as sending specific emails or assigning tasks to team members.

4.4 Scheduling Interviews

Step 1. From the candidate profile, click "Schedule Interview."

Step 2. Select the Interview Type (Phone, Video, On-site, Panel).

Step 3. Select the Interviewers from the list of available team members. The system checks for calendar conflicts.

Step 4. Choose the Date and Time. The system suggests available time slots based on interviewer calendars.

Step 5. Add Interview Notes with focus areas or specific questions for the interviewers.

Step 6. Click "Send Invitation." Calendar invites are sent to both the candidate and the interviewers via email.

4.5 Collecting Interviewer Feedback

After each interview, interviewers receive a feedback request via email and in-app notification. To submit feedback:

Step 1. Click the feedback link in the notification or navigate to Recruitment > My Interviews.

Step 2. Rate the candidate on predefined competencies using the 1-5 rating scale.

Step 3. Write detailed comments about the candidate performance, strengths, and areas of concern.

Step 4. Select your recommendation: Strong Yes, Yes, Neutral, No, or Strong No.

Step 5. Submit the feedback. All feedback is visible to the hiring team but not to the candidate.

Note: Timely feedback submission is critical. Interviewers who have not submitted feedback within 48 hours receive automated reminders.

4.6 Extending Offers

Step 1. Once a candidate receives positive feedback across all interview rounds, navigate to their profile and click "Extend Offer."

Step 2. Fill in the offer details: Position, Salary, Start Date, Probation Period, and any special terms.

Step 3. Select the Offer Letter Template. Templates are pre-configured with company branding and legal clauses.

Step 4. Preview the offer letter and click "Send." The candidate receives the offer via email with a digital signature link.

Step 5. Track the offer status: Sent, Viewed, Accepted, or Declined. The system logs all status changes with timestamps.

4.7 Initiating Onboarding

When a candidate accepts an offer, the system automatically initiates the onboarding process:

Step 1. The candidate status changes from "Offer" to "Onboarding" in the recruitment pipeline.

Step 2. An employee profile is created with the information from the offer letter.

Step 3. The onboarding task checklist is generated based on the configured onboarding template for the department.

Step 4. IT, Facilities, and HR receive automated notifications to prepare workstation, email account, and access credentials.

Step 5. The new hire receives a pre-boarding email with instructions for their first day, documents to bring, and a link to complete personal details online.

Note: Onboarding tasks should be completed at least 2 business days before the employee start date to ensure a smooth first-day experience.

5. Attendance and Leave SOP

5.1 Daily Check-In/Check-Out

NEXUS HRMS provides flexible attendance tracking to accommodate different work arrangements:

Step 1. Log in to NEXUS HRMS and navigate to Attendance from the sidebar.

Step 2. Click the "Check In" button when you start your workday. The system records your check-in time automatically.

Step 3. Click "Check Out" when you finish work. The system calculates the total working hours for the day.

Step 4. For employees working remotely, the system uses IP-based or geolocation check-in as configured by the administrator.

Step 5. If you forget to check in or out, submit a regularization request from the Attendance page. Select the date, actual check-in/out time, and provide a reason. Your manager must approve regularization requests.

Note: The system sends a reminder notification if you have not checked in by your scheduled start time.

5.2 Viewing Attendance Reports

Attendance reports provide insights into individual and team attendance patterns. Navigate to Attendance > Reports to view the following report types: Daily Attendance Summary (shows check-in/out times and working hours for each employee), Monthly Attendance Report (aggregated

view with attendance percentage, late arrivals, and early departures), and Exceptions Report (lists missed check-ins, regularizations, and overtime instances). Reports can be filtered by date range, department, and employee. Export reports to PDF or Excel using the export buttons at the top of each report view.

5.3 Applying for Leave

- Step 1.** Navigate to Attendance > Leave Requests and click "Apply for Leave."
- Step 2.** Select the Leave Type: Casual Leave, Sick Leave, Earned Leave, Maternity/Paternity Leave, or Compensatory Off.
- Step 3.** Choose the Start Date and End Date. For partial-day leave, select the "Half Day" option.
- Step 4.** Enter the Reason for the leave. Medical leaves may require document attachments.
- Step 5.** The system automatically calculates the number of leave days, excluding weekends and holidays based on your branch calendar.
- Step 6.** Click "Submit." The request is routed to your reporting manager for approval.

5.4 Approving/Rejecting Leave Requests

Managers receive email and in-app notifications for pending leave requests. To process a request:

- Step 1.** Navigate to Attendance > Leave Approvals to see all pending requests.
- Step 2.** Review the leave details: employee name, leave type, dates, reason, and remaining leave balance.
- Step 3.** Check the team leave calendar to identify potential conflicts with other team members on leave during the same period.
- Step 4.** Click "Approve" to grant the leave or "Reject" to deny it. You must provide a comment when rejecting a request.
- Step 5.** The employee is notified of the decision via email and in-app notification. Approved leaves are reflected in the attendance calendar immediately.

5.5 Checking Leave Balances

Employees can view their leave balances from the Attendance > My Leaves page. The leave balance card shows the allocated, used, and remaining days for each leave type. Balances are updated in real-time after each leave approval or cancellation. The leave year runs from January to December by default, but this can be configured by the HR administrator. Unused leaves may be carried forward or encashed based on company policy, which is configured in the Leave Policy settings.

5.6 Managing Shift Schedules

For organizations with shift-based operations, NEXUS HRMS provides shift scheduling capabilities. Navigate to Attendance > Shifts to create and manage shift rosters. Define shift timings, assign employees to shifts, and publish the schedule. Employees can view their upcoming shifts and receive notifications about shift changes. The system supports rotating shifts, split shifts, and on-call schedules.

Managers can swap shifts between employees with approval, ensuring coverage is maintained at all times.

6. Payroll SOP

6.1 Running Monthly Payroll

The payroll process must be executed carefully as it directly impacts employee compensation. Follow these steps to run the monthly payroll:

Step 1. Navigate to Payroll from the left sidebar. Verify that all attendance data for the month has been finalized and approved.

Step 2. Click "Run Payroll" and select the payroll period (month and year).

Step 3. The system performs a pre-processing check: validating attendance records, leave adjustments, overtime calculations, and any pending salary revisions. Resolve any flagged issues before proceeding.

Step 4. Review the auto-calculated gross salary for each employee. The system computes basic pay, allowances, and variable components based on the configured salary structures.

Step 5. Process deductions (see Section 6.3 below).

Step 6. Click "Calculate Net Pay" to generate the final net salary for each employee after all additions and deductions.

Step 7. Click "Lock Payroll" to freeze the payroll run. Once locked, no further changes can be made to this payroll period without HR admin authorization.

Note: Payroll must be locked at least 3 business days before the salary disbursement date to allow time for bank file generation and transfer.

6.2 Reviewing Payroll Summary

After running payroll, review the summary dashboard before processing payments. The payroll summary provides: Total Gross Salary (sum of all employee gross pay), Total Deductions (statutory and voluntary), Total Net Pay (amount to be disbursed), and a headcount breakdown by department. Drill down into each section to view employee-level details. Any anomalies (negative net pay, unusually high deductions) are highlighted in red for immediate attention. Use the "Compare with Previous Month" feature to identify significant variances.

6.3 Processing Deductions

Deductions are calculated automatically based on configured rules, but should be reviewed each payroll cycle:

Deduction Type	Calculation Method	Configuration
Income Tax	Progressive tax slabs based on declared regime	Tax Settings > Tax Slabs

Provident Fund	Employee contribution (12% of basic)	Statutory Settings > PF
Professional Tax	Fixed amount per state/city	Statutory Settings > PT
ESI	Employee contribution (0.75% of gross)	Statutory Settings > ESI
Loan EMI	Fixed monthly deduction per loan schedule	Employee Loans Module
Voluntary Deductions	As per employee election (insurance, NPS)	Employee Self-Service

To add a one-time deduction (e.g., salary advance recovery), navigate to Payroll > Adjustments, select the employee, enter the amount and reason, and click "Add." The deduction will be applied in the next payroll cycle.

6.4 Generating Payslips

Step 1. After locking the payroll, navigate to Payroll > Payslips.

Step 2. Select the payroll period and the employees for whom payslips should be generated.

Step 3. Click "Generate Payslips." The system creates PDF payslips using the configured template.

Step 4. Preview payslips before distribution by clicking on individual employee names.

Step 5. Click "Publish to Employees" to make payslips available in each employee self-service portal. Employees receive an email notification.

Note: Payslips for previous months can be regenerated at any time from the Payroll History section if the payroll period is unlocked.

6.5 Tax Computation Overview

NEXUS HRMS supports both Old and New tax regimes as applicable under current income tax laws. Employees can declare their preferred regime and investment declarations from the Tax section of their self-service portal. The system calculates provisional tax liability based on declared income and investments, and provides month-by-month TDS (Tax Deducted at Source) projections. HR administrators can run the "Annual Tax Review" report to verify that TDS deductions are on track for all employees before the financial year ends.

6.6 Bank File Generation

Step 1. After locking payroll and generating payslips, navigate to Payroll > Bank Files.

Step 2. Select the bank format (NEFT, RTGS, or specific bank format like HDFC, ICICI, SBI).

Step 3. The system generates the bank file with employee bank account numbers, IFSC codes, and net salary amounts.

Step 4. Download the file in the required format (CSV, TXT, or XML based on bank requirements).

Step 5. Upload the file to your bank portal or share it with the finance team for processing.

Note: Verify bank account details for all employees before generating the bank file. Incorrect account numbers will result in failed transfers.

7. Performance Management SOP

7.1 Setting Goals (OKR/KPI)

Goals form the foundation of the performance management process. NEXUS HRMS supports both OKR (Objectives and Key Results) and KPI (Key Performance Indicator) frameworks. To set goals:

- Step 1.** Navigate to Performance > Goals from the left sidebar.
- Step 2.** Click "Create Goal" and select the goal type: Individual, Team, or Organization-level.
- Step 3.** For OKRs: Enter the Objective (what you want to achieve) and add 2-5 Key Results (measurable outcomes that indicate progress).
- Step 4.** For KPIs: Define the metric name, target value, unit of measurement, and measurement frequency (weekly, monthly, quarterly).
- Step 5.** Set the goal period (quarter, half-year, or annual).
- Step 6.** Align the goal with parent goals by selecting from the dropdown. This creates a visible goal cascade from organizational to individual level.
- Step 7.** Submit the goal for manager review. Goals become active after manager approval.

Employees should update goal progress regularly. Navigate to your goals and click "Update Progress" to enter the current value and add comments about achievements or blockers. Managers receive notifications when progress is updated and can provide feedback inline.

7.2 Conducting Performance Reviews

Performance reviews are structured assessments conducted at defined intervals. To complete a review:

- Step 1.** When a review cycle is active, navigate to Performance > My Reviews.
- Step 2.** Complete the self-assessment form. Rate yourself on each competency and provide evidence for your ratings.
- Step 3.** Review your goal achievement summary, which is auto-populated from the Goals module.
- Step 4.** Submit the self-assessment. Your manager then completes their evaluation.
- Step 5.** After the manager evaluation, a calibration session may be conducted to ensure fairness across the team.
- Step 6.** The final review is shared with you in a one-on-one meeting. You can acknowledge the review and add comments.

Note: Self-assessments must be completed before the deadline. Late submissions may delay the entire review cycle for your team.

7.3 360-Degree Feedback Process

The 360-degree feedback process gathers input from multiple perspectives: self, manager, peers, and direct reports. To participate as a feedback provider:

Step 1. You will receive a feedback request via email and in-app notification when a review cycle includes you as a reviewer.

Step 2. Navigate to Performance > 360 Feedback and select the pending request.

Step 3. Rate the employee on the defined competencies using the rating scale. Provide specific examples wherever possible.

Step 4. Add written comments for each competency. Constructive, actionable feedback is encouraged.

Step 5. Submit your feedback before the deadline. All feedback is anonymized when shared with the reviewee (except manager feedback).

7.4 Managing Appraisal Cycles

HR administrators create and manage appraisal cycles from Performance > Appraisal Cycles. To create a new cycle:

Step 1. Click "Create Cycle" and enter the cycle name, period, and applicable employee groups.

Step 2. Configure the review stages: Self-Assessment, Manager Review, 360 Feedback, Calibration, and Final Rating.

Step 3. Set deadlines for each stage. The system enforces these deadlines and sends reminders.

Step 4. Publish the cycle. Employees and managers are notified and can begin the review process.

Step 5. Monitor progress from the cycle dashboard. Identify bottlenecks (e.g., pending manager reviews) and send manual reminders if needed.

Step 6. After all reviews are completed, finalize the cycle to lock ratings and trigger downstream processes such as increment letters and promotion workflows.

8. Learning and Development SOP

8.1 Browsing Course Catalog

The Learning & Development module hosts the organization training catalog. Navigate to L&D; from the left sidebar to browse available courses. The catalog displays courses organized by category (Technical Skills, Leadership, Compliance, Soft Skills, Onboarding). Use the search bar to find specific courses by keyword, or apply filters by category, duration, delivery mode (online, classroom, hybrid), and skill level (beginner, intermediate, advanced). Each course card shows the title, brief description, duration, rating from previous participants, and the number of enrolled learners. Click on a course card to view the full details including syllabus, instructor information, and schedule.

8.2 Enrolling in Training

Step 1. Find the desired course in the catalog and click "Enroll."

Step 2. If the course requires manager approval, a request is sent to your manager. Self-paced online courses may allow direct enrollment.

Step 3. For scheduled classroom sessions, select your preferred date and time slot from the available options.

Step 4. After enrollment is confirmed, the course appears on your Learning Dashboard under "My Courses."

Step 5. You will receive email reminders before the course start date. Online courses can be accessed immediately from the Learning Dashboard.

Note: Some mandatory compliance courses are auto-assigned by the system. These appear in your Learning Dashboard with a due date and cannot be dropped without HR approval.

8.3 Tracking Completion

The Learning Dashboard provides a visual overview of your training progress. For each enrolled course, the dashboard shows the completion percentage, time spent, and status (Not Started, In Progress, Completed, or Overdue). Online courses track progress automatically as you complete modules and assessments. Classroom training is marked complete by the instructor after attendance verification. You can download completion certificates from the course detail page after finishing all requirements. Managers can view team-level training completion rates from their dashboard, helping them identify skill gaps and plan future training investments.

8.4 Managing Certifications

The Certifications section tracks professional certifications held by employees. To add a certification, navigate to L&D; > My Certifications and click "Add Certification." Enter the certification name, issuing organization, date obtained, and expiration date (if applicable). Upload the certificate document for verification. The system sends reminders 90, 60, and 30 days before a certification expires, ensuring timely renewal. HR administrators can generate reports on certification coverage across the organization to identify compliance risks or skill gaps that need to be addressed through targeted training programs.

9. Travel and Expense SOP

9.1 Submitting Travel Requests

Step 1. Navigate to Travel & Expense from the left sidebar and click "New Travel Request."

Step 2. Enter the trip details: Destination, Travel Dates, Purpose of Travel, and Project Code (for cost allocation).

Step 3. Specify the travel preferences: Flight class (Economy, Business), Hotel category, and any special requirements.

Step 4. Attach supporting documents such as conference invitations, client meeting confirmations, or project authorization emails.

Step 5. The system provides an estimated cost based on the travel policy for your grade level. Review the estimate.

Step 6. Click "Submit." The request is routed to your manager and, for high-value trips, to the department head for approval.

Note: Travel requests must be submitted at least 5 business days before the travel date. Emergency travel requests require VP-level approval.

9.2 Filing Expense Claims

After completing your trip, file an expense claim to receive reimbursement:

Step 1. Navigate to Travel & Expense > Expense Claims and click "New Claim."

Step 2. Link the claim to an approved travel request, or select "Standalone Expense" for non-travel expenses.

Step 3. Add expense line items: Date, Category (Flight, Hotel, Meals, Transport, Miscellaneous), Amount, and Currency.

Step 4. Upload receipts for each line item. The system supports image and PDF formats. Mobile app users can take photos of receipts directly.

Step 5. The system validates each line item against the company travel policy. Items exceeding policy limits are flagged for manager review.

Step 6. Click "Submit." The claim is routed through the approval workflow.

9.3 Approval Workflow

Expense claims follow a tiered approval process based on the claim amount and the employee grade level. Claims below the threshold (configured by HR) require only the direct manager approval. Claims above the threshold require additional approval from the department head or finance controller. Approvers can approve, reject, or return a claim with comments. Returned claims can be revised and resubmitted. The system maintains a complete audit trail of all approval actions with timestamps and comments. Approvers receive daily digest emails summarizing pending approvals to ensure timely processing.

9.4 Reimbursement Process

Once all approvals are obtained, the claim moves to the finance team for processing. Finance reviews the claim for policy compliance, verifies receipt authenticity, and confirms the bank account details. Approved reimbursements are processed in the next payroll cycle or via a separate bank transfer, depending on the organization policy. Employees receive a notification when the reimbursement is processed, along with the expected credit date. In case of partial approval (where some line items are rejected), the employee is notified with specific reasons for each rejection and can dispute the decision through the helpdesk.

10. Helpdesk SOP

10.1 Creating Support Tickets

- Step 1.** Navigate to Helpdesk from the left sidebar and click "Create Ticket."
- Step 2.** Select the Category that best describes your issue: Technical Issue, Access Request, Payroll Query, Leave Discrepancy, or General Inquiry.
- Step 3.** Enter a clear, descriptive Subject line summarizing your issue.
- Step 4.** Describe the issue in detail in the Description field. Include steps to reproduce the problem, error messages (if any), and the expected outcome.
- Step 5.** Attach screenshots or documents that help illustrate the issue.
- Step 6.** Set the Priority: Low (cosmetic issue), Medium (functionality impacted), High (blocking work), or Critical (system-wide impact).
- Step 7.** Click "Submit." You receive a ticket number for tracking. The ticket is automatically assigned to the appropriate support team based on the category.

10.2 Tracking Ticket Status

Track your tickets from the Helpdesk > My Tickets page. Each ticket displays its current status: Open (awaiting assignment), In Progress (being worked on), Waiting for Response (support team needs additional information), Resolved (fix applied), and Closed (confirmed resolved by requester). When the support team updates a ticket, you receive an email notification with the update details. You can add comments to the ticket at any time to provide additional context. To close a resolved ticket, click "Confirm Resolution." If the issue persists, click "Reopen" to escalate it back to the support team with a new comment.

10.3 Knowledge Base Usage

The Knowledge Base is a self-service repository of articles, how-to guides, and FAQs. Before creating a ticket, search the Knowledge Base for a solution. Navigate to Helpdesk > Knowledge Base and use the search bar or browse by category. Articles are rated by helpfulness, and the most relevant results appear first. If you find an article helpful, click the "Thumbs Up" button to improve its ranking. If an article is outdated or incorrect, click "Report Issue" to notify the content team. Employees are encouraged to contribute articles by clicking "Suggest Article" in the Knowledge Base. Approved contributions are published with the author attribution.

11. Asset Management SOP

11.1 Requesting Assets

- Step 1.** Navigate to Assets from the left sidebar and click "Request Asset."
- Step 2.** Select the Asset Type: Laptop, Monitor, Phone, Software License, Office Furniture, or Other.

Step 3. Specify the required details: preferred specifications, quantity, and justification for the request.

Step 4. If the request is related to a new employee onboarding, link it to the onboarding task for automatic processing.

Step 5. Click "Submit." The request is routed to your manager and the IT/Facilities team for approval and fulfillment.

Note: Standard asset requests are typically fulfilled within 3-5 business days. Urgent requests should be flagged as "High Priority" with appropriate justification.

11.2 Asset Assignment Process

Once an asset request is approved, the IT or Facilities team assigns a specific asset to the employee. The assignment process involves: selecting an available asset from inventory (or procuring a new one if out of stock), recording the asset details (serial number, model, configuration) in the system, assigning the asset to the employee profile with the assignment date, and obtaining a digital acknowledgment from the employee confirming receipt and acceptance of the asset. The employee is responsible for the assigned asset throughout the assignment period and must report any damage or malfunction immediately through the Helpdesk.

11.3 Return and Maintenance

Assets must be returned when an employee leaves the organization, transfers to a different department with different requirements, or when the asset reaches end-of-life. To process an asset return: navigate to Assets > My Assets, select the asset, and click "Initiate Return." The IT/Facilities team inspects the asset for damage, records the condition, and updates the asset status to "Available" or "Under Maintenance." For scheduled maintenance, the system sends reminders based on the maintenance schedule configured for each asset type. Employees must cooperate with maintenance schedules and return assets temporarily if required for servicing. Any damage beyond normal wear and tear may result in a deduction as per the company asset policy.

12. Compliance SOP

12.1 Regulatory Compliance Calendar

The Compliance Calendar provides a centralized view of all regulatory deadlines and filing requirements. Navigate to Compliance > Calendar to view upcoming deadlines organized by month. Each entry shows the regulation name, due date, responsible team, and current status (Pending, In Progress, Submitted, Overdue). The calendar supports multiple regulatory frameworks including labor law filings, tax submissions, PF/ESI returns, and statutory registrations. Color coding indicates urgency: green (on track), yellow (approaching deadline), and red (overdue). HR administrators can add custom compliance events specific to their industry or jurisdiction. The system sends automated reminders at 30, 15, 7, and 1 day before each deadline to the assigned responsible person and their manager.

12.2 Document Submission

Step 1. Navigate to Compliance > Document Submissions to view pending document requirements.

Step 2. Click on a requirement to see the details: document type, required format, submission deadline, and the responsible party.

Step 3. Upload the completed document in the required format (PDF, Excel, or specific statutory format).

Step 4. The system validates the document format and completeness. Incomplete submissions are returned with a list of missing items.

Step 5. After successful validation, the document is routed to the compliance officer for review and approval before final submission.

Step 6. Approved documents are archived in the Compliance Document Repository with full version history for future reference and audit purposes.

12.3 Audit Preparation

NEXUS HRMS provides tools to prepare for internal and external audits. Navigate to Compliance > Audit Prep to access the following features: Audit Checklist Generator (creates a comprehensive checklist based on the audit scope and applicable regulations), Document Readiness Report (shows which compliance documents are complete, pending, or missing), Data Export (generates audit-ready reports from all HR modules including employee records, payroll, attendance, and recruitment), and Gap Analysis (identifies areas where current practices may not meet regulatory requirements). HR administrators should run the Audit Readiness Assessment at least 30 days before a scheduled audit to allow sufficient time for remediation. All audit-related communications and findings should be documented within the Compliance module for traceability.

13. Workflow Builder SOP

13.1 Creating Workflow Definitions

Step 1. Navigate to Workflow Builder from the left sidebar and click "Create Workflow."

Step 2. Enter the Workflow Name and Description. Choose the module this workflow applies to (Leave, Expense, Recruitment, etc.).

Step 3. Define the Trigger Event: what action initiates the workflow (e.g., "Leave Request Submitted," "Expense Claim Created").

Step 4. Add workflow steps by clicking "Add Step." Each step represents an action or approval checkpoint in the process.

Step 5. For each step, define: the action type (Approval, Notification, Data Update, or Conditional Branch), the assigned actor (specific role, reporting manager, or department head), and the timeout period (maximum time allowed before escalation).

Step 6. Configure conditional logic using the rule builder. For example: "If claim amount > 10,000, route to Finance Controller; otherwise, route to Direct Manager."

Step 7. Test the workflow using the built-in simulator to verify that all paths lead to the expected outcomes.

Step 8. Click "Publish" to activate the workflow. Published workflows take effect immediately for new submissions.

Note: Existing in-progress submissions continue on the previous workflow version. Only new submissions use the updated workflow.

13.2 Configuring Approval Steps

Approval steps are the most common workflow component. When configuring an approval step:

- Select the Approver Type: Direct Manager, Department Head, Role-Based (e.g., Finance Controller), or Named Individual.
- Enable "Multi-Level Approval" if the step requires sequential approvals from multiple people.
- Configure "Parallel Approval" if multiple approvers need to review simultaneously (all must approve, or majority rule).
- Set the "Auto-Approve After" timeout to prevent bottlenecks. If an approver does not act within the specified time, the system auto-approves or escalates.
- Define escalation rules: who to notify when an approval is overdue (the approver manager, or a designated backup).
- Add approval conditions: "Only require this approval if" rules based on form data (amount, department, employee grade, etc.).

13.3 Setting Up Triggers

Triggers are events that automatically initiate a workflow. NEXUS HRMS supports the following trigger types:

Trigger Type	Description	Example
Record Created	Fires when a new record is created in a module	New employee added triggers onboarding workflow
Record Updated	Fires when a specific field changes	Employee status change triggers asset return workflow
Date-Based	Fires on a specific date or recurring schedule	30 days before probation end triggers review workflow
Threshold Exceeded	Fires when a value crosses a defined limit	Expense claim over limit triggers extra approval
Manual Trigger	Fires when a user clicks a custom action button	Manager clicks "Initiate PIP" for an employee

To configure a trigger, navigate to Workflow Builder > Triggers, click "Add Trigger," select the type, configure the conditions, and link it to the appropriate workflow. Triggers can be enabled or disabled without modifying the workflow itself.

13.4 Monitoring Workflow Instances

The Workflow Monitor provides real-time visibility into all active workflow instances. Navigate to Workflow Builder > Monitor to see: Active Instances (workflows currently in progress with current step highlighted), Pending Approvals (approval steps waiting for action), Stale Workflows (instances that have been in a single step beyond the configured timeout), and Completed Instances (finished workflows with full execution history). Administrators can take manual actions on any instance: skip a step, force-approve, or cancel the workflow. All manual interventions are logged with the administrator name, timestamp, and reason. The analytics dashboard shows workflow efficiency metrics: average completion time, approval rates, and bottleneck identification, helping you continuously optimize your workflows.

14. Troubleshooting Guide

14.1 Common Issues and Solutions

Issue	Possible Cause	Solution
Cannot log in	Incorrect password or expired session	Use "Forgot Password" to reset. Clear browser cache and cookies.
Page not loading	Network connectivity or browser compatibility	Check internet connection. Use Chrome, Firefox, or Edge. Disable ad blockers.
Check-in button greyed out	Already checked in or outside scheduled hours	Verify you have not already checked in today. Contact HR for schedule issues.
Leave balance shows zero	Leave policy not assigned or new leave year reset	Contact HR admin to verify your leave policy allocation.
Payslip not visible	Payroll not yet locked or published	Wait for HR to complete the payroll run and publish payslips.
Cannot submit expense claim	Missing required fields or invalid receipt format	Ensure all mandatory fields are filled and receipts are in JPG, PNG, or PDF format under 5MB.
Workflow stuck in pending	Approver unavailable or timeout not configured	Contact the approver directly or ask HR admin to escalate.
Search returns no results	Incorrect filters or insufficient permissions	Clear all filters and retry. Verify you have access to the requested records.

14.2 Error Messages Explained

Error Code	Message	Meaning and Action
ERR-401	Unauthorized Access	Your session has expired. Log out and log in again.
ERR-403	Permission Denied	You do not have the required role for this action. Contact your administrator.
ERR-404	Record Not Found	The requested record may have been deleted or you lack access. Verify the record ID.
ERR-409	Conflict	Another user has modified this record simultaneously. Refresh the page and retry.
ERR-422	Validation Error	Submitted data failed validation. Check the highlighted fields and correct the errors.
ERR-500	Internal Server Error	An unexpected error occurred. Try again later. If persistent, create a helpdesk ticket.

14.3 Contacting Support

If you are unable to resolve an issue using the troubleshooting steps above, contact the NEXUS HRMS support team through the following channels:

- Create a support ticket via the Helpdesk module (preferred method, ensures tracking and SLA compliance).
- Email: support@nexushrms.com for non-urgent issues. Response time: within 4 business hours.
- Phone: +1-800-NEXUS-HR for urgent/critical issues during business hours (9 AM - 6 PM, Monday to Friday).
- Emergency: For system-wide outages affecting all users, contact the IT emergency line listed on the company intranet.

Note: Always include your employee ID, the module affected, and steps to reproduce the issue when contacting support.

14.4 Frequently Asked Questions

Q: How do I reset my password?

A: Click "Forgot Password" on the login page. Enter your registered email address. You will receive a password reset link valid for 24 hours. If you do not receive the email, check your spam folder or contact HR.

Q: Can I access NEXUS HRMS from my mobile device?

A: Yes, NEXUS HRMS is fully responsive and works on mobile browsers. A dedicated mobile app is also available for iOS and Android. Download it from the App Store or Google Play using your corporate email.

Q: How do I update my bank account details for payroll?

A: Navigate to your Profile > Personal Info > Bank Details. Update the account number and upload a copy of your bank passbook or cancelled cheque. Changes require HR verification before being applied to payroll.

Q: What should I do if my manager is unavailable to approve my request?

A: Contact HR admin to reassign the approval to an alternate approver. You can also use the "Escalate" button on the pending approval to notify the next-level manager after 48 hours of inactivity.

Q: How can I export data from NEXUS HRMS?

A: Most list views and reports have an "Export" button. Choose CSV, Excel, or PDF format. Bulk data exports require HR admin permissions. All exports are logged for compliance purposes.